EDITOR'S NOTE

The State of the Prisons was first published in 1777. Howard made additions and alterations in subsequent editions in 1780 and 1784, and gave an account of his observations after that date in a volume called *An Account of the Principal Lazarettos in Europe*, published in 1789. This volume was really a continuation of *The State of the Prisons*, giving rather more information about hospitals than that book, and rather less about prisons. A second volume of *Lazarettos* was published after Howard's death in 1791, and a fourth edition of *The State of the Prisons*, a reprint of the third, appeared in 1792, but there has been no reprint of any kind since that date.

The text given here is taken from the third edition of *The State of the Prisons* (the last published in Howard's lifetime) and from the first edition of *Lazarettos*. In view of the fact that the former work contains five hundred and five quarto pages and the latter two hundred and seventy-two, it is evident that all that Howard wrote could not be reproduced in an "Everyman" volume. Nor would it be desirable to reproduce it all. The greater part of both books consists of detailed descriptions of hundreds of prisons at home and abroad, all of which, with a few exceptions abroad and none at home, have long since been pulled down, and these descriptions now make tedious and unprofitable reading. Accordingly the following pages contain an abridgment of *The State of the Prisons*, together with some extracts from the volume on lazarettos. All Howard's general observations on prisons have been retained as written, but a number of descriptions of individual prisons have been omitted altogether, and others much condensed, the principle aimed at being to retain only so much as will give a clear idea of the conditions prevailing at the time. A complete list of the English prisons found by Howard to be inhabited will be found among the statistical tables at the end of the book.

All descriptions of hospitals and lazarettos have also been omitted, but his description of his own experience of quarantine has been retained, for its intrinsic interest. Some observations on schools and education, which appear in the *Lazaretto* volume, also seemed too interesting to be omitted.